ROYAL ASTRONOMICAL SOCIETY OF CANADA
SASKATOON CENTRE

SASKATOON SKIES

NOVEMBER 2026
VOLUME 57 • ISSUE 08



EDITOR
Zo Chapman

Monthly digest of centre news, observing dates, and sky highlights

Photo: © 2019 Tim Yaworski/timkip.com

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JOIN US!

Welcome New Members

The Saskatoon Centre offers a one-year revolving membership. You will be a member for the next 12 months no matter when in the year you join. Members are encouraged to renew early to avoid disruption in publications. Renew through the National Office here.

Benefits of Joining

- Meet other knowledgeable & friendly amateur astronomers
- Use of the Sleaford Observatory (training required)
- Use of the U of S Observatory (training required)
- Saskatoon Skies Newsletter
- Observer's Handbook
- Borrow the Centre's projector to give astronomy outreach presentations
- Rent telescopes
- Use of the Centre library
- Journal of the RASC (electronic format)



Photo credit: Валерий Линк, Pexels

OBSERVATORY INFO

The observatory is open free of charge on the first and third Saturdays of every month. Any visitor may view celestial objects through the telescope.

Address: 108 Wiggins Rd (U of S Campus)
Current hours: 7 pm - 9:30 pm (subject to change)
Observatory website
Observatory Facebook

MEMBERSHIP PRICING

Regular	Youth
$121.00	$71.10

Family
$115.50
+ $41.00/additional adult
+ $22.20/additional youth

CALENDAR OF EVENTS

NOVEMBER 7

Observer's Group at Sleaford

Viewing starts at dusk at the Sleaford Observatory dark site. Arrive early to set up! Members and their guests only.

NOVEMBER 16

Saskatoon Centre General Meeting

Monthly general meeting at the U of S Observatory. All members and guests are welcome. Starts at 8 pm.

MEETING INFORMATION

7:00 PM – Executive Meeting
8:00 PM – General Meeting
8:15 PM – Main Program

Members may attend the executive meeting as observers if they wish. A Zoom registration link and phone-in numbers will be emailed to members.

After registering, an email invitation will be sent with a link to join via computer or a number to phone in.

When joining via computer, participants will have to first download and install the Zoom app, if they have not done so already.



Photo: M45 captured with a Skywatcher 6" astrograph and ZWO 533MCPro camera without filters from 25km east of Saskatoon. 1hr 15min stack. Tim Yaworski

EVENT FEATURE

"CREEPY CONSTELLATIONS AND OTHER SCARY STUFF"

Tim Yaworski participated as one of the presenters at the recent dark skies at Beaver Creek event on October 30. He did a presentation featuring tales of the evening sky in the fall and winter. He also did a presentation on light pollution and the importance of dark skies. This was part of their Halloween event that also featured information on bats, a bat walk and a zombie walk. Ron Waldron joined Tim to help show off the night sky but unfortunately all that we saw were clouds.





UPCOMING CELESTIAL EVENTS



Full Moon – November 24

The first of three consecutive “supermoons”, which occur when the Moon is within 90% of perigee (closest to Earth in its elliptical orbit).



Leonids Meteor Shower – November 17 - 18

Peaks overnight from Nov 17 - 18. Under ideal conditions, you can expect see 10 - 15 meteors per hour, created by debris left behind by comet Tempel–Tuttle, which orbits the Sun every 33 years.



Mars - Jupiter Conjunction – November 14

The two planets will pass approximately 1.2 degrees apart (about the width of a pinky finger held at arm's length). Spot the conjunction from Saskatoon in the wee hours of Nov 15 (late at night but before sunrise).

HELPFUL OBSERVING RESOURCES

Clear Dark Sky website – Saskatoon
Amateur astronomers’ best friend. It shows at a glance when, in the next 96 hours, we might expect clear and dark skies for one specific observing site.

Environment Canada
Provides weather information for astronomy.

Airmass.org – Astronomical Object Visibility Plotter
Shows the observability of celestial objects by plotting their altitude and airmass over the course of the night and throughout the year.

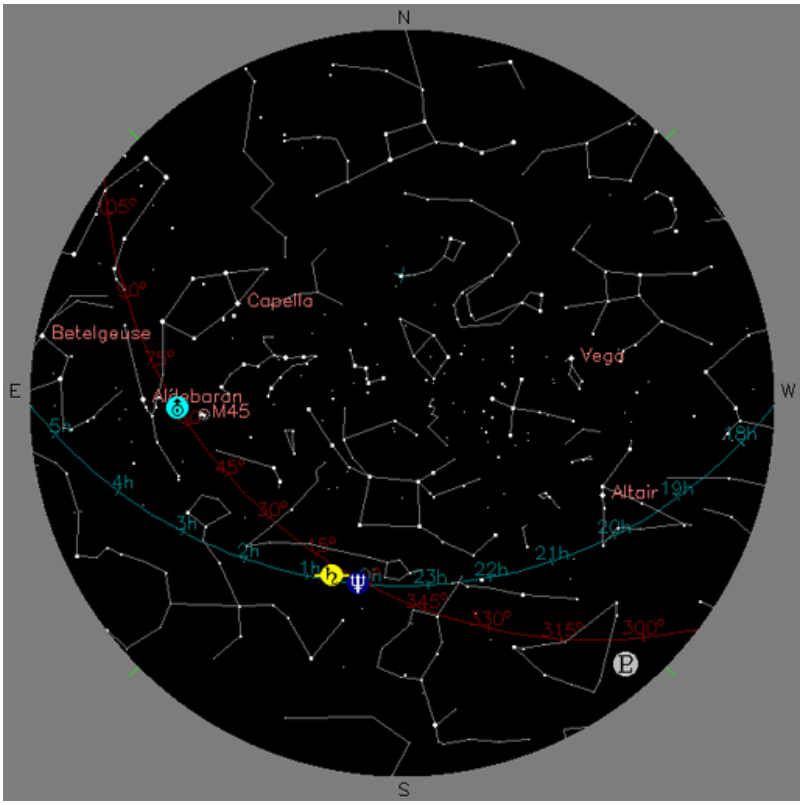
Annotated Finding Charts
Create annotated finding charts for a given astronomical target, by specifying either the coordinates, or an object name.

Saskatchewan Light Pollution Abatement Committee
Learn about light pollution initiatives in the Land of Living Skies.

Dark Sky International
Learn about international dark sky conservation efforts and how we can help.

WHAT'S UP THIS MONTH?

If you walk outside at 9 PM near the middle of the month (Nov 14) in Saskatoon and look up, this is what you'll see! *Source:* Your Sky by Fourmilab.



Object	Altitude	Azimuth	Up?
Sun	-33.894	104.537	Set
Mercury	-36.979	124.873	Set
Venus	-42.130	140.033	Set
Moon	-6.248	55.051	Set
Mars	-19.799	-155.62	Set
Jupiter	-21.191	-155.60	Set
Saturn	36.805	-21.861	Up
Uranus	28.09	-88.296	Up
Neptune	36.546	-13.346	Up
Pluto	4.511	40.791	Up

WINTER STARGAZING TIPS

Use red light only
Use a flashlight or headlamp with a dim red light and avoid bright screens.

Dress warmly
Layers are your friend. Wear warm layers, gloves, a hat, and thick-soled shoes.

Plan your night before you go
Before you leave, write down a plan of which objects you'd like to view and their locations in the sky to minimize downtime in the cold.

FEATURED PHOTO

: Lorie Tedford
Saskatoon Centre member



Description: Butterfly Nebula (NGC 6302), taken with Radian Raptor 61 in Grasslands National Park.

SUBMIT YOUR OWN PHOTO

Have a night sky image to share? Send your best astronomy photo to the editor for a chance to be featured in a future issue of Saskatoon Skies.

- ✓ Include your name, a photo of yourself (if desired), and a short description of who you are.
- ✓ Include the date and location of the photograph, equipment details (if applicable), and a one-sentence caption.

MEETING MINUTES

Minutes of the Monthly Executive Meeting - RASC Saskatoon Center
Monday, October 19th, 2026 - 7:00 pm
Hybrid: U. of S. Observatory and Zoom

Attending: Les Dickson, Brent Burlingham, Darrell Chatfield, John Takala, Joelle Sheard-Patrick, Jeff Swick, Tenho Tuomi, Nick Larson, Lisa Caldwell
Call to order 7:00 pm - John Takala (President and Chair)

1. Call for additional announcements/items to add to the agenda - none.
2. Approval of the May meeting minutes as circulated in the June meeting invite and newsletter. Moved by Brent Burlingham, seconded by Les Dickson, carried.
3. Announcements from the chair - Tenho Tuomi to step down as website coordinator.
4. Reports from the Executive Council:
    a. President's Report - John Takala - none at present.
    b. Financial Report - Les Dickson
        i. Shared end-of-year financial report until the end of September 2026.
        ii. Expenses - star party: major expense was insurance and maintenance costs
        iii. Notable items - sold snowblower, purchased telescopes for rental program.
        iv. Motion to approve the year-end report. Moved by Darrell Chatfield, seconded by Joelle-Sheard Patrick, carried.
    c. Fundraising - Verity Moore-Wright - Verity Moore-Wright is stepping down from position.
    d. National Council Rep - Joelle Sheard-Patrick
        i. AGM in person this year in Toronto in May.
    e. Activities Coordinator -Joelle Sheard-Patrick
        i. Ideas:
            1. The Girl Guides had requested our members to do an activity with them again.
            2. Wildwood School had requested our presence in April. Details to come.
            3. Open House in Early Spring out at Sleaford potentially.
    f. Sleaford Updates - Darrell Chatfield
        i. Went out to do the first cut with the fixed mower.
        ii. Friendly reminder to check all doors before leaving to make sure they are closed tightly and locked.
    g. Media Coordinator - Jeff Swick - none to report.
    h. SSSP 2026 - John on behalf of Rick Huziak.
        i. The weather did not cooperate, but still a good turnout! Official attendance was 324 people.
        ii. Talks were well attended; tried trivia social for the first time, Jeff did a telescope walk about again.
        iii. Special thanks to Kathy and Barb for taking over the BBQ at short notice.
        iv. Planning for the next SSSP starting in December.

MEETING MINUTES

6. Old Business
    a. Library Outreach - Joelle Sheard-Patrick
        i. Two more scopes have arrived. They will provide a handout for each rental for the person to complete for observing programs with National.
        ii. Going to brainstorm ideas to have outreach activities with the library.
7. New Business
    a. Smart scopes
        i. One of the Dwarfs is having rotation issues. It is getting fixed.
        ii. Most of the Dobs are rented out.
    b. Telescope Replacement Parts
        i. Need to return some items that can't be mounted on the scopes for a credit.
    c. Gordon Sarty - Telescopes for Sale
        i. Potentially set up an event for members and nonmembers to sell and buy equipment.
    d. Motion to hire someone to set up our finances under QuickBooks by Les Dickson, seconded by Brent Burlingham, carried.

Motion to adjourn. Moved by Jeff Swick, seconded by Joelle Sheard-Patrick. Carried.

MEETING MINUTES

Minutes of the Monthly General Meeting - RASC Saskatoon Center
Monday, October 19th, 2026 - 8:00 pm
Hybrid: U. of S. Observatory and Zoom

1. Sharing/Networking Time 8:00-8:15 pm
2. Call to order: 8:19 pm - John Takala
3. Call for additional items or changes to the agenda
4. Call out to new members/guests: None
5. Adoption of the May General meeting minutes as circulated in the June meeting invite and newsletter. Moved by Les Dickson, seconded by John Takala. Carried.
6. Executive Meeting Summary - John Takala
7. Elections (**see next page**)
8. Program
    a. Astrowizard and Astrostack - Jeff Swick
9. Call to adjourn

MEETING MINUTES

Position	Name
President	John Takala
Vice President	Nick Larsen
National Council Rep.	Lisa Caldwell
Secretary	Lorie Tedford
Treasurer (Acting)	Les Dickson
Newsletter Editor	Zo Chapman
Speaker Coordinator	OPEN
Fundraising Coordinator	Sierra Laroque
Web Content Editor	Zo Chapman & Lyndon Whitfield (possibly)
Librarian/Archivist Sleaford Maintenance Coordinator	Darrell Chatfield
Observers/Imaging Group Coordinator	Brent Burlingham
Smart Scope Rental Coordinator	Joelle Sheard-Patrick, Lorie Tedford
Photographers	George Charpentier, Colin Chatfield
Media Coordinator	Jeff Swick
SSSP Chair	Rick Huziak
SSSP Committee	George Charpentier, Andrew Kostiuk, Gordon Sarty, Greg Fusick, Joelle Sheard-
Sleaford Joint Committee	Yannis Pahatouroglou, Darrell Chatifeld
Board of Directors	George CHarpentier, Mark de Jonh, Yannis
Constitution Committee	Les Dickson

SLEAFORD REPORT

Updates on Saskatoon Centre's dark sky observing site

Hello again everyone:

John and I got out to Sleaford today, Oct 22/26 to do some work at our site, namely to try and mouse proof a few areas among other jobs, since it was such a nice day.

Two areas of concern happened to be in the bathroom. There was a fairly wide gap on the floor below the S facing wall, and below the E facing wall. So after careful sweeping, I made 5 pieces of tin from roof flashing that I had on hand. These were screwed down to secure. (We at first thought it was possible to crawl underneath the warm-up shelter to see if any tin had come down allowing mice entry, but that idea quickly went away!)

Next, I tried to replace the red outside bulbs on the N of the building which let people know that the site is in use, but I couldn't get them out. I will look at that again later on with another removal method.

Then I applied some plumbers putty sealant to the entry points of the power to the equipment shed, S side.

Now while I was doing all of this, John pruned back the thicker weeds/trees around and inside the U. Of S. Compound and sprayed round-up on the weeds. He also assisted me where necessary.

One thing we made note of was that we need to haul out all the wood from under the warm-up shelter in spring. Any good pieces can be kept in our maintenance shed.

So I would say that we had a good day. I want to thank John for all his help.

Darrell Chatfield
Sleaford Site Coordinator

SLEAFORD REPORT

Updates on Saskatoon Centre's dark sky observing site











BOOKS FOR SALE

All books are in either new, or like new condition. Please email at novachat@sasktel.net or text/call 306-222-0515 if you want a particular book or to make arrangements. All books being sold by Darrell Chatfield.

Deep-Sky Observers Handbook

Volume 1–5
Enslow-Lutterworth

$40.00

International Encyclopedia of Astronomy

1987
Patrick Moore · Color

$10.00

Backyard Astronomers Guide

2008
T. Dickinson & Alan Dyer · Color

$25.00

Atlas of Deep Sky Splendors

1978
H. Verhenberg · B & W

$22.00

Amateur Astronomers Catalog of 500 Deep Sky Objects

Vol 1 · 1980
R. Morales · B & W

$15.00

Observing the Constellations

1989
J. Sanford · Color charts

$10.00

EQUIPMENT FOR SALE

2 – 1.25" rack and pinion focusers — **$20.00 each**
Brand new, never used. Inset diameter 57mm. Heavy duty with metal knurled knobs. All have boxes.

Original Celestron orange tube C5" scope — **$250.00**
With tangent arm and fork arms. SCOPE ONLY. No tripod or wedge. 5x30 finder, 1.25" visual back, diagonal, eyepiece, lens cap, metal case. Used as a spotter scope. Not a mark on the tube. Clean looking.

1.25" eyepiece extender, 3" long — **$20.00**

1.25" Celestron off axis guider — **$45.00**
With 12.5mm eyepiece. Can be illuminated. New.

Celestron 1.25" reticle — **$20.00**
Can be illuminated.

3 – 1.25" visual backs (new) — **$10.00 each**

1.25" tele-extender, 3.5" long — **$20.00**

1.25" to 0.965" visual back — **$10.00**

Camera to visual back adapter — **$10.00**
Lightly used

Threaded visual back to 16mm male threads camera adapter — **$10.00**

Original orange tube Celestron finder — **$65.00**
10x40mm. 304mm (12") long. Comes with bracket meant for a C8" telescope but would fit other scopes. Not a mark on these items.

6" primary mirror — **$85.00**
In a 3-point adjustable mirror cell. Some mirror spots. Nice condition.

7" diameter x 48" long aluminum Newtonian tube — **$75.00**
Ivory exterior with blackened interior. Also has a focuser. Finder bracket supplied as is. There may be some packing tape on the outside that needs to be removed.

Celestron CPC Deluxe 9.25 HD computerized telescope — **$2200**
The same scope installed on the International Space Station by Chris Hadfield. Used primarily for public outreach programs, but its weight and my age are not as compatible as they used to be. Minor scratches on the OTA tube. Two of the plastic hinges on the tripod spreader broke and were repaired with metal. All original accessories included plus a Celestron Lithium battery pack, homemade Bahtinov focusing mask and solar filter. New MSRP $6253. Currently backordered at Ontario Telescopes for $5279. My used unit offered for $2200. Specs can be found here. Call/text Tim 306-880-0720 or tim@timkip.com.

TELESCOPES FOR RENT

AVAILABILITY OVERVIEW

Saskatoon Centre has made its telescopes available for rent to RASC members on a monthly basis. We have three Sky-Watcher 8 inch Dobsonian telescopes, each with a kit of eyepieces and Antares 8x50 right angle finder scopes. Also we have one Telrad Reflex Sight.

The club now has three smart telescopes available for RASC members on a monthly basis – one SeeStar s50 and two Dwarf 3's. Please note that one Dwarf 3 will not be available for rent during April Astronomy month as it will be used for outreach initiatives. You will need to supply your own tripod for the Dwarfs.

TELESCOPE INVENTORY

Sky-Watcher 8" Dobsonian
3 available, each with a kit of eyepieces and an Antares 8x50 right angle finder scope

SeeStar s50 smart telescope
1 available

Dwarf 3 smart telescope
2 available, bring your own tripod.

Telrad Reflex Sight
1 available



RENTAL RATES AND DEPOSITS

TELESCOPE	RATE	DEPOSIT
8" Dobsonian	$20 per calendar month	**$40.00**
SeeStar s50 or Dwarf 3	$25.00 per calendar month	**$50.00**

Deposits are due at time of pick up and refundable upon return.

RENTAL PROCEDURE

Email **sk_centre@rasc.ca** with the following information:

- Your name and email address.
- Which telescope you wish to borrow.
- When you want to pick up the telescope.
- How long you anticipate borrowing the telescope.

OBSERVING CERTIFICATES

The RASC offers observing certificates for members who observe all objects in each of the following lists: the Messier Catalogue, the Finest NGC Catalogue, the Deep-Sky Challenge Objects and Deep-Sky Gems. It also offers the Explore the Universe Certificate for novice observers, the Explore the Moon Certificate for beginning members, and the Isabel Williamson Lunar Observing Certificate and the Double Stars Observing Certificate for intermediate to advanced members. Astroimaging certificates are available for those with a photographic bent.



MESSIER CLUB
Certified at 110 Objects
R. Huziak, G. Sarty, S. Alexander, S. Ferguson, D. Chatfield, T. Tuomi, L. Scott, G. Charpentier, B. Johnson, L. Dickson, B. Burlingham, N. Jensen, Donna-Lee May

CHATFIELD BINOCULAR CERTIFICATE
Certified at 35 to 40 Objects
T. Tuomi, R. Huziak

FINEST NGC CLUB
Certified at 110 Objects
R. Huziak, G. Sarty, D. Chatfield, T. Tuomi

EXPLORE THE UNIVERSE
Certified at 55 to 110 Objects
T. Tuomi, B. Gratias

ISABEL WILLIAMSON LUNAR OBSERVING CERTIFICATE
Certified at 140 Objects
T. Tuomi, N. Jensen

EXPLORE THE MOON CERTIFICATE
T. Yaworski

HERSCHEL 400 CLUB
Certified at 400 Objects
R. Huziak, D. Chatfield, T. Tuomi

HERSCHEL 400-II CLUB
Certified at 154 Objects
D. Chatfield

Questions?
Click here to learn more about RASC Observing Programs or contact the RASC Observing Committee Chair with any questions or comments.

CERTIFICATE PROGRESS

CERTIFICATION	NAME	OBSERVATION COUNT
MESSIER CLUB		
	Ron Waldron	108
	Brent Gratias	104
	Marcel MüllerGoldkuhle	94
	Wade Selvig	75
	Wayne Schlapkohl	43
	Ellen Dickson	34
	Graham Hartridge	9
CHATFIELD BINOCULAR		
	Jim Goodridge	12
FINEST NGC CLUB		
	Larry Scott	110
	Scott Alexander	97
	Norma Jensen	83
	Sandy Ferguson	23
	George Charpentier	13
	Brent Burlingham	97
EXPLORE THE UNIVERSE		
	Wayne Schlapkohl	55
	Jim Goodridge	35
EXPLORE THE MOON		
	Brent Gratias	37
HERSCHEL 400 CLUB		
	Gordon Sarty	251
	Scott Alexander	117
	Larry Scott	45
	Sandy Ferguson	18
HERSCHEL 400-II CLUB		
	Tenho Tuomi	378
	Rick Huziak	246
LEVY DEEP-SKY GEMS		
	Tenho Tuomi	150
	Darrell Chatfield	70

ABOUT US

The Saskatoon Centre of the Royal Astronomical Society of Canada brings people together to explore the night sky, share knowledge, and inspire curiosity about the Universe. Whether you're new to astronomy or a seasoned observer, you're welcome here.

About Saskatoon Skies

Saskatoon Skies is published monthly by the Saskatoon Centre of the RASC. Distribution is approximately 80 copies per issue. This newsletter is also posted on our Saskatoon Centre website as a PDF file and can be downloaded free of charge. Articles may be reprinted without expressed permission (unless otherwise indicated), provided that proper source credit is given.

- **Zo Chapman** — Newsletter Editor
- **Les & Ellen Dickson** — Copy & Collate
- **Mark de Jong** — Labels & Temps

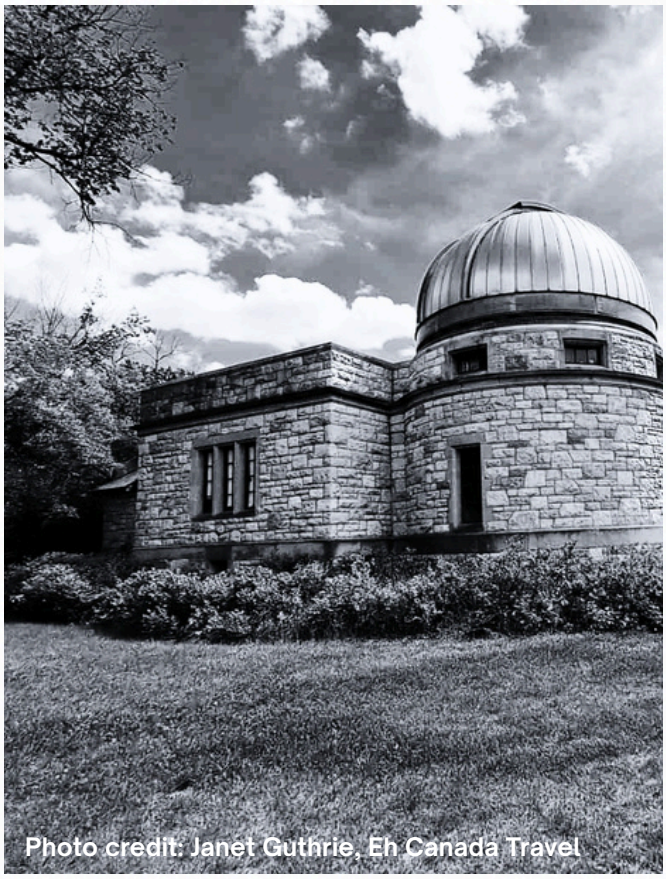


Photo credit: Janet Guthrie, Eh Canada Travel

Centre Main Officers

- **John Takala** — President
- **Nick Larsen** — Vice-president
- **Lorie Tedford** — Secretary
- **Les Dickson** — Treasurer
- **Lisa Caldwell** — National Council Representative

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Donate to the Royal Astronomical Society of Canada here.

Submit content

Saskatoon Skies welcomes unsolicited articles, sketches, photographs, cartoons, and other astronomy or space science material. Text should be sent by email to the editor in MS Word or text format. Images (new or old): any format, sent by e-mail as attached files. **Deadline for submission of all articles for an upcoming issue is the first Friday of each month!**

Advertise

Saskatoon Skies accepts commercial advertising. Please email the editor for rates. Members can advertise non-commerceal items for free.

About the Editor



Hello all! I'm originally from Atlanta and moved to Saskatoon in 2023. I have a BSc in Astrophysics from Georgia State University and a MSc in Data Science from Georgia Tech. I currently work as a data scientist at the Alberta Machine Intelligence Institute. In the past, I researched active galactic nuclei (AGN) at GSU and also interned at NASA. I've recently joined the RASC and am excited to be part of the Saskatoon Centre. You'll start to see more of me at monthly meetings and observing nights. Looking forward to getting involved and getting to know all of you more. –Zo